Early Childhood Environmental Rating Scale

Circle Time:

- Good morning Song
- How many students are here this morning? Count the number of students. (24. Math in daily events 3.1)
  - Who is not here? Count the number not present. (24. Math in daily events 7.3)
- Calendar review:
  - What is today's Day/Date?
  - What was yesterday's Day/Date?
  - What date is tomorrow Day/Date?
  - How many days until the weekend?
- Weather: (22. Nature /Science 3.2)
  - What is the weather like today?
  - Do you think we will be able to go outside?
  - Let's check the temperature outside. Teacher helps meteorologist with reading the thermometer.
  - Announces temperature and records it on a chart/graph (23. Math materials 7.1)
- Do we need to water our plant today? (22. Nature/Science 5.2)
  - When do we feed (Name of Plant) ?
  - What do we feed him?
  - How much water should he get?
  - Let's measure? Teacher helps "Botanist" pour water in the planter. (24. Math in daily events 3.1)
- Do we need to feed our fish today? (22. Nature/Science 5.2)
  - When do we feed (Name of fish)?
  - How much do we give him?
  - Teacher helps "Veterinarian" feed the fish.
  - Counts the pellets.

- Read a story – Select carefully. Practice, Practice, Practice. Use Props.
- Finger Play
  - Math (Example: 5 little speckled frogs/monkeys/duck) Encourage children to use their fingers to count.
  - Rhyming words: Frog/Log, Pool/cool, be/tree, Bed/Head/Said (19. Music 7.2)
- Select centers
  (Remind children how many are allowed in each center)
  If child chooses Manipulatives, light table or science say " You can go to the Square tables"
  If child chooses Art "You can go to the long rectangle table" (23. Math 3.2)

4. Space for Privacy

- Consider a private space for any child that may not be able to play well in a group. Example: Child does not like to share legos. Allow him to play at a table alone with the legos.

- Allow one child to go to the listening center.

5. Child-related display

- Staff use display to encourage informal conversation with children. Example: handwashing display reviewed each time. Point to the display, read the steps. Start the timer. (5 Child-related display 7.2)

NOTE:

- Some display is related to topics of current interest to children in the group. (5. Child-related display 5.2)

- Half of display is related to topic of interest (5. Child related display 7.1)

- One third of the display should be children's artwork (5. Child related display 5.3)

- Three dimensional, child created work is displayed, in addition to flat work. (5, Child related display 7.4)

7. Gross Motor Equipment

- Seven gross motor skills must be observed:

Climbing

Swinging

Jumping

Hopping

Jump Rope

Hula Hoop

Tossing into a container

Catching

Throwing

Kicking

Peddling

Steering

- Helmets required (7. Gross motor equipment 7.2)

17. Fine Motor

- Show interest in Fine Motor toys (maniplulatives) ask about color, shape, what they are building. (17. Fine Motor 5.3)
- Have conversations (back and forth with child) about materials they are using. Show them how to use the materials. Help children select materials. (17. Fine Motor 7.1) Two different children.
- Talk about the picture the puzzle makes. (17. Fine Motor 7.3)

18. Art

- Identify colors, shapes seen in the child's creation. (18. Art 3.3)
- Have conversations with children about their work Example: " Tell me about your picture. Tell me about your playdough structure. (18. Art 5.3) Observe twice
- Print what the child said on the drawing. Example: "This is a picture of my house" . Write those exact words. (17. Fine Motor 7.3)
- 3-D art MUST be displayed.

19. Music and Movement

Identify rhyming words in finger plays or songs. Point them out to children. (19. Music 7.2)

20. Blocks

- Staff make positive comments about what children are building. Ask children about the shape of the blocks they are using. (20. Blocks 3.4)
- Staff have many conversations about what children are building. Talk about shapes, sizes, how tall, count blocks. (20. Blocks 5.5)
- Staff point out math concepts that are demonstrated in unit blocks in a way that interests children Example: Suggest using a ramp to see how fast cars can go down. See if weight of the objects going down the ramp make a difference. Discuss more or less, discuss size and shapes. (20, Blocks 7.3)

21. Dramatic Play

- Staff carry on conversations with the children as they play, joining in but not taking over. Talk about the role they are playing. (21. Dramatic Play 5.3)

- Staff talk about print and numbers in dramatic play in a way that is meaningful to children. Discuss menus with prices for restaurants; pretend to call Door dash, Mom or Dad, Pizza Hut. Call out the phone number, How much$ the order costs. (21. Dramatic Play 7.2)

22. Nature/Science

- Help children identify the names of animals that children see in the viewer or specimens. (22. Nature/Science 3.2)
- Staff use and talk about nature/science materials with children. Discuss the kalidescope, how do we use the magnifying glasses, listen to the large conch shells. (22. Nature/Science 5.2)
- Staff model concern for the environment (Remind children to turn off water or lights to save resources. Recycling. Discuss how insects can be helpful. (22. Nature/Science 5.3)

23. Math materials and activities

- Staff frequently join in children's play with math materials. Ask questions. Respond to children's questions. Show enthusiasm. Teach children how to use materials. (23. Math materials and activities 5.2) observe three times.
- Staff ask children questions about math materials/activities that stimulate reasoning. Example: "What do you think would happen if we weigh these two items. Which one weighs the most?" (23. Math and materials 7.2)
- Some appropriate math activities requiring more teacher input are used. Sort seashells by type and size. Compare more and less. Read thermometer to chart daily temperature. Measure while doing a cooking activity. (23. Math and materials 7.3)

24. Math in daily events

- Count or use math words during transitions or routines.. Count the number of children lined up to go outside/return inside. Remind children to wash hands for 20 seconds. Remind children of how many are allowed in each center. (24. Math in daily events 3.1)
- Staff use math talk as children play with non math areas. Count blocks in child's tower. Match blocks to size and shape during clean up. Mention number of colors in child's painting. (24. Math in daily events 3.2)
- Staff use math talk during large group. Example: Count the number of children present at school today. Determine how many are absent. Measure water or food given to plants or fish. (24. Math in daily events 3.3)
- Staff encourage math learning as part of daily routines. Name rectangle and square tables in classroom. Setting the table. Use measuring cup to serve portions at meals. (24. Math in daily events 5.1). Observe twice
- Engage children in conversations about math as they play in non-math areas. Example: use measuring cup to water plants. Measure height of block construction. Ask about the price of items on the menu. Ask about how many different colors are in the children art painting.

Sort bugs in science by size/type. Have a tea party; how many tea cups, plates are needed. Helpers for Lunch – how many milks do we need? How many forks and napkins. Measure food with serving spoons for lunch. (24. Math in daily events 5.2) Observe twice

- Help children connect printed numbers or shapes with everyday use. Example: Count the number of days on the calendar until the week end/field trip/ graduation. Talk about the numbers on the clock and what that means in terms of going outside. Talk about the shape of traffic signs while in the block area. (24. Math in daily events 7.1)
- Staff use questions while interacting with children to explain their own math reasoning. Example: "How do you know if one more person can play in this area?", " How do you know if you have enough milk for everyone?" (24. Math in daily events 7.2)
- Children aged 4 and older given more complex math-related tasks. Example: count the number of children in the group to determine how many are NOT present. Use a tape measure to see if the table will fit. (24. Math in daily events 7.3)
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25. Understanding written numbers

- Some play materials with numbers are accessible during the observation. Example toy telephones, play money, number stencils in writing area, numbers on play kitchen furnishings. When children play with these materials staff point out the numbers and talk about them in a way that interests children. Example: " I'm going to call Pizza Hut. Their number is 404-123-4567. " Hello Pizza Hut can I get a large pizza? How much is it? How long will it take." "can you take my order" I want the eggs and milk. How much is that?" (25. Understanding written numbers. 3.3)
- Staff sometimes relate print numbers to corresponding number of pictures or objects. Example: staff points to a number on puzzle or in a counting book and helps child count number of pictures that match. (25. Understanding written numbers 3.4)
- Staff show children how to use materials and talk about the meaning of printed numbers Example: Help child read the numbers on the outside thermometer/ ruler/measuring cup. Count numbers use "first", "second", "third". (25. Understanding written numbers 5.3)
- Staff frequently show children how to use the numbers materials and talk about the meaning of printed numbers. Example: Value of money. Cost of meals on printed menus. Tape measure readings. Measuring cups. Thermometers. Clocks. (25. Understanding written numbers 7.3) Observe twice
- Printed numbers are sometimes related to number of fingers shown by staff or children. Example: use fingers when reading a number book, looking at a number poster, when using toys showing numbers. (25. Understanding written numbers 7.4)
- NOTE:

  5.1 MUST have 3 different play materials that help show children the meaning of printed numbers are accessible during the observation. Example: puzzle with numbers on one piece and the number of dots on the matching piece, puzzle with numbered fingers on a hand, matching picture/number card game, simple number card games.

  7.1 MUST have 5 different play materials

26. Promoting Acceptance of diversity

- Inclusion of diversity is observed as a part of learning activities, in addition to diversity in materials. Example sing a song in more than one language, play music from varying cultures, use sign language for some words. (26. Promoting acceptance of diversity 7.1)
- Staff have positive conversations with children discussing the benefits of similarities and differences among people. (26. Promoting acceptance of diversity 7.2)
- NOTE:
  5.1 At least two different types of dramatic play props representing different races or cultures are included in dramatic play.
  5.2 At least 10 easily visible examples of diversity, with at least 1 example in each of the following: books, displayed pictures, accessible play materials.

32. Discipline

Please read